

PUERARIA

purple flowers, followed by long, slender, hairy pods. In cold areas, is best grown as an annual, H to 15ft (5m) or more. Z9–11 ***P. thunbergiana***. See *P. montana* var. *lobata*.

PULMONARIA

*Lungwort*

BORAGINACEAE

Genus of mainly spring-flowering perennials, some semievergreen or evergreen, with small, overwintering rosettes of leaves. Fully hardy. Prefers shade; grow in any moist but well-drained soil. Propagate by division in spring or fall. See also feature panel p.261.

***P. angustifolia*** (Blue cowslip). Clump-forming, usually deciduous perennial. H 10–12in (25–30cm), S 1½ft (45cm). Has lance-shaped, unspotted, mid-green leaves, 16in (40cm) long. In spring, bears heads of tubular, 5-lobed, boragelike, sometimes pink-tinged, deep blue flowers. Z4–8. **‘Azurea’**, H and S 1ft (30cm), has dark green leaves and pinkish buds that open to rich gentian-blue flowers.

***P. ‘Beth’s Pink’***. Semievergreen, clump-forming perennial. H 10in (25cm), S 20in (50cm). Has ovate to lance-shaped, hairy, dark green leaves, spotted silvery-white. In early and mid-spring, bears heads of tubular, 5-lobed, boragelike, purplish-pink flowers. Z4–8

***P. ‘Blue Ensign’***. Deciduous, clump-forming perennial. H to 14in (35cm), S to 1½ft (45cm). Has broadly ovate, hairy, dark green leaves. In spring, produces heads of tubular, 5-lobed, boragelike, rich blue flowers. Z4–8

***P. ‘Cotton Cool’***. Semievergreen, clump-forming perennial. H 8–12in (20–30cm), S 20in (50cm). Has narrowly elliptic, hairy, dark green leaves marked almost entirely with silver. In spring, bears heads of tubular, 5-lobed, boragelike, pink flowers that age to blue. Z4–8

***P. ‘Diana Clare’***. Vigorous, clump-forming, semievergreen perennial. H 8–12in (20–30cm), S 1–1½ft (30–45cm). Has elliptic to lance-shaped, silver-green leaves, lightly speckled dark green near the margins. Bears funnel-shaped, violet-blue flowers from late winter to late spring. Z4–8

***P. ‘Excalibur’*** (illus. p.261). Vigorous, semievergreen, clump-forming perennial. H 1ft (30cm), S 20in (50cm). Has narrowly lance-shaped, hairy, silver leaves with narrow, green edges. In early and mid-spring, pink buds open to heads of tubular, 5-lobed, boragelike, light blue flowers. Z4–8

***P. ‘Glacier’***. Semievergreen, clump-forming perennial. H 8–12in (20–30cm), S 20in (50cm). Has broadly ovate, hairy, mid-green leaves spotted with silver. In early and mid-spring, bears heads of tubular, 5-lobed, boragelike, pale blue and pale pink flowers. Z4–8

***P. ‘Ice Ballet’***. Vigorous, semievergreen, clump-forming perennial. H 1ft (30cm), S 20in (50cm). Has broadly ovate, hairy, mildew-resistant, mid-green leaves well spotted with silver. In early and mid-spring, bears heads of large, boragelike, tubular, 5-lobed, pure white flowers. Z4–8

***P. ‘Lewis Palmer’*** (illus. p.261). Vigorous, semievergreen, clump-forming perennial. H 14in (35cm), S 1½ft (45cm).

Has ovate, hairy, silver-spotted, mid-green leaves. In early and mid-spring, heads of tubular, 5-lobed, boragelike, clear blue flowers open from pinkish buds. Z3–8

***P. longifolia***. Clump-forming, deciduous perennial. H 1ft (30cm), S 1½ft (45cm). Bears very narrowly lance-shaped, dark green leaves, to 1½ft (45cm) long, spotted with silvery-white. Heads of tubular, 5-lobed, boragelike, vivid blue flowers are borne in late spring. H6. **‘Bertram Anderson’** has longer, narrower leaves especially well spotted with silver and bears brighter blue flowers.

***P. ‘Margery Fish’*** (illus. p.261). Semi-evergreen, clump-forming perennial. H 1ft (30cm), S 20in (50cm). Has narrowly lance-shaped, hairy, mid-green leaves marked heavily with silver. In early spring, heads of tubular, 5-lobed, boragelike, pink flowers gradually turn blue as they age. Z3–8

***P. ‘Mary Mottram’*** (illus. p.261). Vigorous, semievergreen, clump-forming perennial. H 14in (35cm), S 20in (50cm). Has ovate, hairy leaves marked heavily with silver, each with a narrow, green margin. In early spring, bears heads of large, tubular, 5-lobed, boragelike, pink and violet flowers. Z3–8

***P. ‘Mawson’s Blue’*** (illus. p.261). Semi-evergreen, clump-forming perennial. H to 14in (35cm), S to 1½ft (45cm). Has ovate, hairy, mid-green leaves, bronze tinged when young. In early spring, heads of tubular, 5-lobed, boragelike, azure-blue flowers often open before leaves fully develop. Z3–8

***P. ‘Ocupol’***. See *P. OPAL*.

***P. officinalis ‘Sissinghurst White’***. See *P. ‘Sissinghurst White’*.

***P. OPAL (‘Ocupol’)*** (illus. p.261). Semi-evergreen, clump-forming perennial. H to 14in (35cm), S 1–1½ft (30–45cm). Has ovate, hairy, silver-spotted, mid-green leaves. In spring, heads of tubular, 5-lobed, boragelike, glowing, pale blue flowers open from pink buds. Z3–8

***P. rubra*** (illus. p.261). Evergreen, clump-forming perennial. H to 16in (40cm), S 3ft (90cm). Has ovate, velvety, mid-green leaves. Heads of tubular, 5-lobed, boragelike, brick-red flowers open from late winter to early spring. Z3–8. **‘David Ward’** (illus. p.261) has narrow, white-edged, sage-green leaves and pale red flowers; needs a sheltered spot.

***P. saccharata*** (Jerusalem sage). Evergreen, clump-forming perennial. H 1ft (30cm), S 2ft (60cm). Long, elliptic leaves are variably spotted with creamy-white. In spring, bears funnel-shaped flowers, opening pink and turning to blue. Z3–8.

**Argentea Group** cultivars have almost completely silver leaves; the flowers open red and age to dark violet. **‘Leopard’** has silver-spotted, dark green leaves and reddish-pink flowers that fade to lilac.

**‘Mrs. Moon’** bears leaves spotted liberally with silver and heads of pinkish-mauve flowers. **‘Sissinghurst White’** see *P. ‘Sissinghurst White’*.

***P. ‘Sissinghurst White’***, syn. *P. officinalis ‘Sissinghurst White’*, *P. saccharata ‘Sissinghurst White’*, illus. p.254.

***P. ‘Trevi Fountain’***. Robust, clump-forming, semievergreen perennial. H 1ft (30cm), S 26in (65cm). Has lance-shaped, silver-spotted, mid-green leaves. In spring,

short stalks bear cobalt-blue flowers just above the foliage. Z4–9

***P. ‘Weetwood Blue’***. Usually semi-evergreen, clump-forming perennial. H 8in (20cm), S 20in (50cm). Has lance-shaped, hairy, green leaves occasionally spotted with white. In spring, bears heads of tubular, 5-lobed, boragelike, clear blue flowers that darken as they age. Z3–8

PULSATILLA

RANUNCULACEAE

Genus of perennials, some with overwintering foliage, grown for their fernlike leaves and often silky-hairy flowers and feathery seed heads. Has fibrous, woody rootstocks. Leaves increase in size after flowering. Good for large rock gardens. Fully hardy. Needs full sun and humus-rich, well-drained soil. Dislikes root disturbance. Propagate by root cuttings in winter or by seed when fresh. ☉ All parts may cause mild stomach upset if ingested, and, in rare instances, contact with the sap may irritate skin.

***P. alpina*** (Alpine pasque flower) illus. p.332. **subsp. *apifolia*** (syn. *P.a. subsp. sulphurea*) is a clump-forming perennial. H 6–12in (15–30cm), S to 4in (10cm). Has feathery, soft green leaves. Bears upright, bell-shaped, soft pale yellow flowers in spring, followed by feathery, silvery seed heads. Z5–8. **subsp. *sulphurea*** see *P.a. subsp. apiifolia*.

***P. halleri*** illus. p.334. **subsp. *grandis*** see *P. vulgaris* subsp. *grandis*. **subsp. *slavica*** is a clump-forming, deciduous perennial. H and S to 8in (20cm). In spring, erect stems bear cup-shaped, deep violet-purple flowers above deeply dissected, woolly, mid-green leaves, followed by silvery, silky seed heads. Z5–8

***P. occidentalis***. Clump-forming perennial. H 8in (20cm), S 6in (15cm). Has finely dissected leaves. In late spring to early summer, solitary, nodding buds develop into erect, goblet-shaped, white flowers, stained blue-violet at the bases outside, sometimes flushed pink. Feathery, silvery seed heads follow. Z5–8

***P. vernalis*** illus. p.349.

***P. vulgaris*** (Pasque flower) illus. p.334. **subsp. *grandis*** (syn. *P. halleri* subsp. *grandis*) is a clump-forming perennial. H 4–8in (10–20cm), S 8in (20cm). Bears large, upright, shallowly bell-shaped, lavender-blue flowers, with bright yellow centers, in spring before the finely divided, downy leaves emerge. Z5–8

PUNICA

*Pomegranate*

LYTHRACEAE/PUNICACEAE

Genus of deciduous, summer-flowering shrubs and trees, grown for their bright red flowers and yellow to orange-red fruits, which ripen and become edible only in warm climates. Frost hardy. Needs a sheltered, sunny position and well-drained soil. Propagate by seed in spring or by semripe cuttings in summer.

***P. granatum*** (Pomegranate). Deciduous, rounded shrub or tree. H 20ft (6m), S 15ft (5m). Has narrowly oblong leaves and, in summer, funnel-shaped, bright red flowers, with crumpled petals. Fruits are

round and deep yellow to orange. May be grown in a southern or eastern aspect, either free-standing or, in frost-prone climates, against a wall. Z9–11. **var. *nana*** (Dwarf pomegranate) illus. p.340.

PUSCHKINIA

ASPARAGACEAE

Genus of dwarf, *Scilla*-like bulbs, grown for their early spring flowers. Fully hardy. Needs sun or partial shade and humus-rich soil, with grit or sand added to ensure good drainage. Plant in fall. Dies down in summer. Propagate by offsets in late summer or by seed in fall.

***P. libanotica***. See *P. scilloides* var. *libanotica*.

***P. scilloides* var. *libanotica***, syn. *P. libanotica* (Striped squill), illus. p.421.

**‘Alba’** illus. p.415.

PUYA

BROMELIACEAE

Genus of evergreen, rosette-forming perennials (bromeliads), grown for their overall appearance. Frost hardy to frost tender. Requires full light and well-drained soil. Water moderately during the growing season, sparingly at other times. Propagate by seed or by offsets in spring.

***P. alpestris***. Evergreen perennial with stout, branched, prostrate stems. H to 6ft (2m), S 10ft (3m). Linear, tapering, arching, bright green leaves are fleshy, with hooked, spiny teeth along the edges and dense, white scales beneath. Tubular, deep metallic-blue flowers, aging to purple-red, are borne in stiff, erect panicles in early summer. Z9–11

***P. chilensis*** (illus. p.471). Evergreen, upright perennial with a short, woody stem. H 15ft (5m), S 6ft (2m). Stem is crowned by a dense rosette of linear, tapering, arching, fleshy, gray-green leaves edged with hooked, spiny teeth. In summer, bears erect, branched panicles of tubular, metallic- or greenish-yellow flowers. Z9–11

PYCNOSTACHYS

LAMIACEAE/LABIATAE

Genus of evergreen perennials or soft-stemmed shrubs, grown for their whorled clusters of deep blue flowers. Frost tender. Grow in bright light and fertile, well-drained soil. Propagate by stem cuttings in early summer.

***P. dawei*** illus. p.473.

***P. urticifolia***. Strong-growing, erect, soft-stemmed shrub with square stems. H 8ft (2.5m), S 4ft (1.2m). Has opposite, narrowly ovate, toothed, hairy, mid-green leaves. Bears whorls of small, tubular, deep blue flowers in racemes in winter. Z11–12 (min. 54°F/12°C)

PYRACANTHA

*Firethorn*

ROSACEAE

Genus of evergreen, spiny, summer-flowering shrubs, grown for their foliage, flowers and fruits. Fully to frost hardy. Requires a sheltered site in sun or partial shade and fertile soil. To produce a compact habit on a plant grown against